conceptual form in concept-laden perception (***savikalpa-pratyaksha***) that analyses the content of sensation and identifies the object in terms of the categories (***padartha***) of substance, generic property and particular-quality.

Ramanuja thinks that *nirvikalpaka-pratyaksha* is just as specific as ***savikalpaka-pratyaksha***; the difference lies just in the fact that awareness of one individual does not involve cognition of the recurrence of a generic property in many individuals of the same kind.

Navya-Nyaya thinkers maintain that one is not directly aware of pre-conceptual awareness, which is knowable only by inference. ***Savikalpa-pratyaksha*** is the expression in concepts of the content of primary perception and always involves words. It comprehends the complex relationship between the object and its properties.

Further reading: Bartley 2002; Matilal 1986

Nirvishesha (absence of differentia): reflecting the experience of profound meditative contemplation in which the mind is emptied of distracting thoughts and feelings, ***Advaita Vedanta*** maintains that ultimate reality beyond all oppositions is changeless consciousness void of differentiating features.

Vedantins recognise sense-perception (*pratyaksha*), inference (***anumana***) and scriptural language (*shabda*) as reliable means of knowledge (***pramana***). Anything genuinely existent can in principle be known by one or more of those methods. Scripture is our only way of knowing anything outside the scope of sensory perception and inference. ***Ramanuja*** argues that the *Advaitin* cannot establish his view that reality is ultimately non-differentiated contentless consciousness. All ***pramana***-based understanding is necessarily of particularised entities with identifiable features. If reality were non-differentiated, our recognised means of knowing could not operate.